



Chatham County Fire Department



Contact Us

CHATHAM COUNTY FIRE CONTACT US FORM

If this is an emergency, please call 911.

This form is for general information and is not monitored continuously.

Freedom of information Requests should be submitted at

<https://chathamcountyga.justfoia.com/publicportal/home/newrequest> (<https://chathamcountyga.justfoia.com/publicportal/home/newrequest>)

Please use the form below to submit your request and provide your name and contact information.

First Name*

Michael

Last Name*

Woodcock

Phone Number

[REDACTED]

Email*

[REDACTED]

Subject*

Fire Safety & Occupancy Issues at AirBNB at 8611 Whitefield Ave

Message*

I am submitting this complaint regarding the short-term rental located next to our home, at 8611 Whitefield Ave, Savannah GA, 31406. The operation of this STR has repeatedly disrupted the residential character of our neighborhood and interfered with the quiet enjoyment of our neighborhoods' properties, with numerous violations of the standards outlined in the Chatham County Short-Term Rental Ordinance, including some which must have been put in place for fire safety.

1. Noise, Parties, and Police Response

There have been multiple late-night parties extending into early morning hours, several of which required police involvement. In one instance, guests informed us they planned to host a party; approximately 25 vehicles arrived at 11 PM, and the gathering became loud and disorderly.

2. Illegal and Unsafe Parking

The STR does not have adequate parking capacity for the guests he allows over the legal occupancy limit. Guests routinely park in prohibited areas, including a nearby church lot clearly marked "Parking for Church Only - Tow Away Zone" and left lots of trash and litter behind on church property. Guests have also driven across our lawn, sinking in axle deep, causing damage, leaving ruts, and requiring wrecker recovery at 2am on a work night. This demonstrates the owner is not adhering to standards requiring a parking diagram, and there is insufficient parking for his guests.

3. Trespass and Safety Concerns

Guests have walked through our yard, shining flashlights into our windows because they were confused about where to go. This has created significant safety concerns for our household, especially considering the violent past with parties at the AirBNB property.

4. Serious Public Safety Incidents

A shooting occurred at this STR, with multiple homes and a vehicle struck by gunfire, as reported by local news. This incident has deeply affected the sense of safety and well-being in our neighborhood. The owner still allows parties on his properties. Police have responded to multiple calls for things ranging from "alcohol overdose" to "Marijuana use complications", and they've always been helpful, but it does not act as a deterrent of future behavior when there's different guests every night.

5. Occupancy Violations

The owner advertises the property as sleeping 10 guests, despite having only 3 bedrooms. Under County rules (two adults per bedroom plus two additional adults), the maximum legal occupancy is 8. Advertising and hosting above this limit is a direct violation of the STR ordinance.

6. Failure to Prevent Nuisance

The cumulative issues: noise, illegal parking, property damage, trespass, excessive occupancy, and a major violent incident show that the owner is not meeting the ordinance requirement to prevent nuisance or protect the quiet enjoyment of neighboring properties.

Request for County Review

We respectfully request that the County review this STR for compliance with occupancy limits, parking requirements, and nuisance prevention obligations, and take any enforcement action deemed appropriate.

Thank you for your attention to this ongoing matter.

Send Message

Useful Information

CHATHAM COUNTY FIRE HEADQUARTERS

📍 1249 Eisenhower Drive
Savannah, Georgia 31406
(https://www.google.com/maps/place/1249+Eisenhower+Dr,+Savannah,+GA+31406/@32.0052695,-81.0977113,16z/data=!3m1!4b1!4m6!3m5!1s0x88fb75b620902f7b:0x21f9cd76044f212d!81.0977113!16s%2Fg%2F11c4tbxxhj?entry=tту&g_ep=EgoyMDI1MDIxNy4wLkxMDS0ASAFQAw%3D%3D)

☎ (912) 219-0420 (tel:9122190420)

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First Name*

Last Name*

Phone Number

Email*

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Message*



Your message has been sent. Thank you!



Useful Information

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(/)

Chatham County Fire Department

<https://fire.chathamcountyga.gov/aboutus/contactus>



1249 Eisenhower Drive

Savannah, Georgia 31406

(https://www.google.com/maps/place/1249+Eisenhower+Dr,+Savannah,+GA+31406/@32.0052695,-81.0977113,16z/data=!3m1!4h1!4m6!3m5!1s0x88fb75b620902f7b:0x21f9cd76044f212d!81.0977113!16s%2Fg%2F11c4tbxxhj?entry=tту&g_ep=EgoyMDI1MDIxNy4wLkxMDS0ASAFQAw%3D%3D)

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